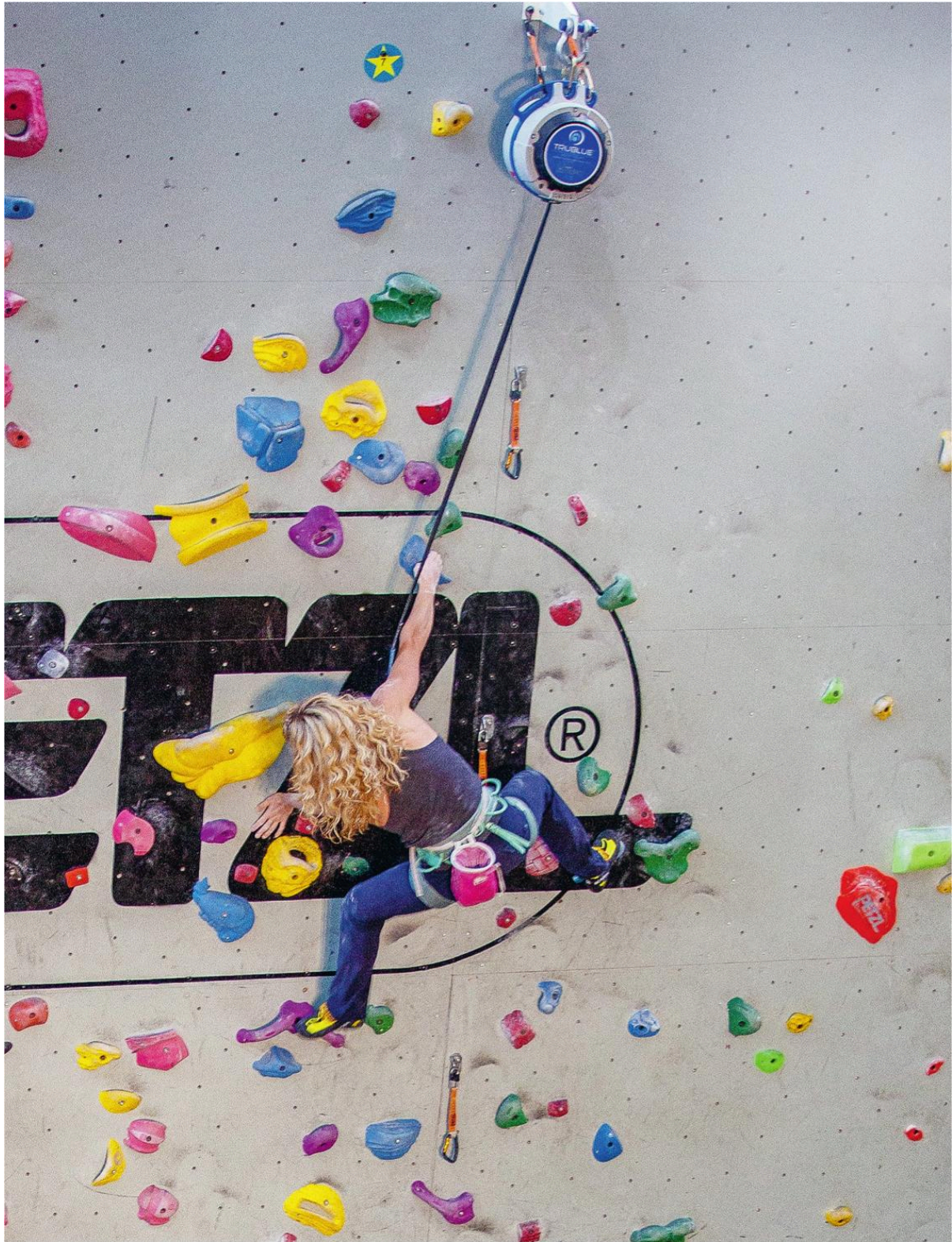


WARMING UP

WHY SHOULD I WARM UP?

WARMING UP PREPARES us to perform physically, technically and mentally, and also reduces our risk of injury. The warm-up should consist of a general part and a specific part. The general part can include running, jumping, push-ups, squats and similar activities, with the goal being to activate the whole body and to use the larger muscle groups. The warm-up is also a good time to incorporate some injury prevention exercises, where you can practise movement patterns that are the opposite of what you'll face when climbing. For youths and adults the general part should last for at least 10 minutes, while it should last a little while longer for children – for at least 20 minutes.

The specific part should be climbing based. The most common approach is to start with some easy climbing on good holds, before progressing to increasingly harder climbing. For this part of the warm-up you can – and should – add technical elements that you wish to work on. To properly warm up your fingers to reduce the risk of injury, it is recommended that you do over 100 moves during your warm-up and before you increase the level of difficulty. Your warm-up should also be specifically targeted towards whatever the main part of your training session will consist of. If you're going to do steep bouldering, the last part of your specific warm-up should consist of steep moves to make sure that your arms, upper body and core muscles are properly warmed up and ready. If you're going to do vertical lead climbing, your warm-up should reflect this, by focusing on warming up your fingers and adding in hip-mobility exercises. In addition to preparing yourself physically, warming up will also mentally prepare you for performing. Having the specific part of your warm-up resemble what you'll be doing in the main part of your session will have a positive effect on how well prepared you will be mentally for what is about to happen.



Begin with easy traversing on good holds or some easy top-roping. Then progress to more dynamic moves. One simple exercise is to double-dyno between good holds while keeping your feet on the wall. Remember that climbing is all about fun and freedom of movement, so try to let loose mentally and climb dynamically, playing around with dynos, to get some flow in your movement. In our experience, many climbers are more agile during the main part of their session if they take this approach during their warm-up.

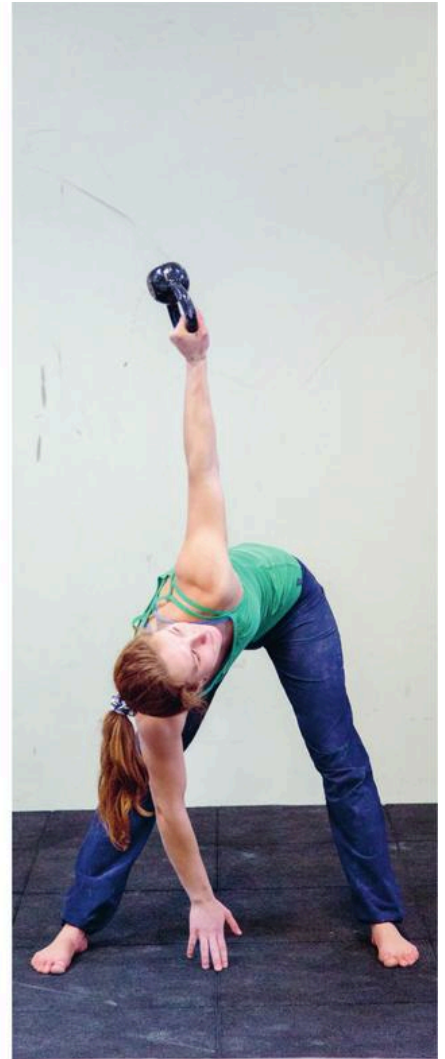
THE WARM-UP PROGRAMME

GENERAL PART

Start your warm-up by activating your blood circulation and larger muscle groups. For example, you can use a skipping rope, go for a run, or walk or run up some stairs. To activate your upper body you can add in some burpees in sets of 10. Alternate between these variants for about 10 minutes, and you'll be ready to move on with the following exercises:



COSSACK SQUATS: Complete one set of ten repetitions to each side.



STANDING ROTATIONS: Complete one set of ten repetitions to each side.



THORACIC BRIDGE: Complete one set of five repetitions to each side.

SPECIFIC PART

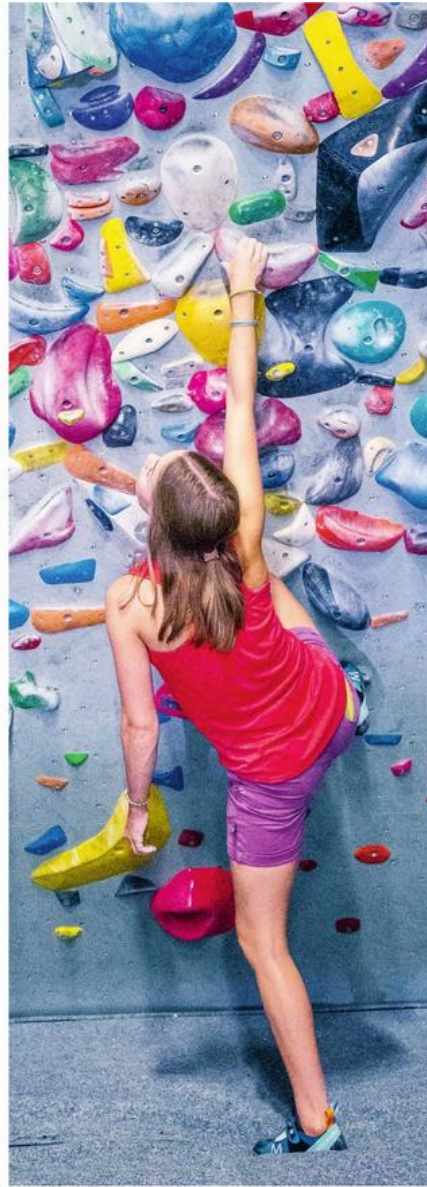
As mentioned earlier, we recommend completing at least 100 moves during your warm-up, independent of what you will be training afterwards, and this is best accomplished on a rope or by traversing the bouldering wall. During this part of your warm-up you have the opportunity to practise clipping technique, footwork, resting and dynamic moves. The last part of the specific warm-up should resemble what you'll focus on during your main training session. We have included suggestions here for exercises to do before your most intensive sessions, where you'll need some extra warming up before you're ready to really start training.

**PULL-UPS:**

During your warm-up we recommend that you drop all the way down until your arms are straight and start the pulling motion by pulling your shoulder blades down and together, rotating your elbows in towards each other and steadily pulling up through the whole movement. Complete three sets of five repetitions. Use an elastic band or a pulley system to take some of the load off, to ensure it's an actual warm-up and not strength training.

POWER PULL-UPS:

Use an elastic band and complete four to six pull-ups where you generate as much speed as possible when pulling up. If you're going to be bouldering or climbing hard you can add some high-speed pull-ups at the end of your warm-up to activate the upper body musculature.



DEADHANGS:

Use a pulley system to take some of the load off. Complete five sets of 5- to 10-second hangs using different grip positions (for example, open hand, half crimp, three-finger open, and so on).

KICK STARTS:

Start with one hand and one foot on the wall and spring from the floor to catch a hold on the wall with your free hand. Complete six different-length kick starts for each arm, varying the holds.

JUMP TO EDGE OR HOLD:

Jump to and grab a one- or two-handed hold. Complete six jumps in total and vary the hold type and distance to the hold/s.